

VYNKÆR
ヴィンケア
鍛魂

APPAREL BRAND BIBLE
+ COLLECTION 001

FORGED SOUL

Discipline. Control. Ascension.

Version 1.0 | 11 September 2026

YVNK // TRAINING DIVISION

01 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

The Brand

A training uniform for people who treat self-reconstruction as a discipline.

BRAND IN ONE SENTENCE

VYNKÆR is dark performance apparel for strength-driven people who train to become more capable, controlled and difficult to break.

"FORGED, NOT BORN."

VYNKÆR is not gym-motivation merchandise. It is a uniform for deliberate transformation. The aesthetic is severe, but the philosophy is not nihilistic: train hard, move well, build strength, retain control and emerge more capable than before.

Core philosophy

Pillar	Meaning	Design consequence
Discipline	Consistency after motivation disappears.	Restrained graphics, repeated systems, purposeful detail.
Control	Strength without mobility or self-command is incomplete.	Athletic cuts, movement-first construction, clean hierarchy.
Endurance	Progress is built by surviving difficult cycles without losing form.	Durable fabrics, reinforced trims, aged/forged textures.
Ascension	The target is not perfection; it is becoming harder to defeat than yesterday.	Vertical forms, spear geometry, upward visual movement.

Brand manifesto

The body is material. Training is the forge. Discipline is the hammer. VYNKÆR exists for the repeated act of choosing the harder standard: one more clean rep, one more controlled session, one more day of becoming. We do not worship suffering. We use resistance to build capability. We do not chase noise. We build presence.

BRAND RULE

Darkness is the visual language. Capability is the actual message.

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Audience & Positioning

Who it is for — and who it is not for.

Primary audience

VYNKÆR is designed first for 18–34-year-old strength and hybrid-training consumers who care about both physical performance and identity. The line should remain unisex in design language even when specific fits are cut for different bodies.

- Strength-training and hypertrophy-focused gym members who prefer darker, premium aesthetics.
- Hybrid athletes combining lifting, conditioning, mobility and athletic development.
- Consumers drawn to gothic fantasy, dark medieval, industrial and Japanese-influenced visual culture.
- People who want gym clothing that feels like a personal uniform rather than loud fitness merch.
- Founders, creatives, students and professionals who use training as a structure for discipline outside the gym.

Psychographic target

They value	They reject
Self-mastery over external validation	"Alpha/sigma" posturing
Quality and silhouette over giant logos	Cheap motivational slogans
Capability, strength and athleticism	Aesthetic-only fitness identity
Mythic atmosphere without cosplay	Direct copies of games, manga or characters
A sense of belonging without forced positivity	Generic "community" language with no substance

Market position

Position VYNKÆR between premium gymwear, dark streetwear and performance apparel. It should feel more cinematic and authored than mainstream fitness brands, but more wearable and technically credible than novelty gothic merchandise.

POSITIONING TEST

If a piece looks like it belongs only at a convention, it is too literal. If it could come from any fitness brand, it is too generic.

03 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

Brand Architecture & Voice

A disciplined system, not a pile of slogans.

Architecture

Level	Name	Role
Master brand	VYNKÆR	Identity, philosophy, core mark.
Descriptor	TRAINING DIVISION	Signals apparel/performance context.
Collection	001 — FORGED SOUL	Seasonal narrative and art direction.
Product families	FORGE / COMBAT / DISCIPLINE / ASCENSION	Organises silhouette and use case.
Product	FORGE TEE 01	Specific launch item.

Voice

The voice is terse, elevated and controlled. It may sound severe, but never juvenile, hateful, macho for its own sake or obsessed with pain. Copy should read like fragments from a training doctrine.

Use	Avoid
FORGED, NOT BORN.	BEAST MODE
THE BODY OBEYS.	NO PAIN NO GAIN
DISCIPLINE OUTLIVES MOTIVATION.	HUSTLE HARDER
STRENGTH UNDER CONTROL.	ALPHA / SIGMA language
TRAIN. ENDURE. ADAPT. ASCEND.	Long inspirational paragraphs on garments

COPY STANDARD

Short enough to remember. Strong enough to mean something. Never written only to fill space.

04 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

Logo Hierarchy

The uploaded crest remains the authoritative primary mark.



The logo combines the VYNKÆR monogram/crest, the wordmark, ヴィンケア and 鍛魂. Its weapon-like vertical geometry makes it the strongest identifier in the system and should not compete with excessive secondary graphics.

Hierarchy

Tier	Lockup	Best use
01 Primary	Crest + VYNKÆR + ヴィンケア + 鍛魂	Campaigns, packaging, hero hoodie, website.
02 Crest	Symbol only	Chest marks, cap front, shorts, zipper pulls, social avatar.
03 Wordmark	VYNKÆR	Small embroidery, hem labels, technical tops.
04 Division	VYNKÆR // TRAINING DIVISION	Neck tape, packaging, campaign footer.
05 Japanese	ヴィンケア / 鍛魂	Secondary accent only; never stronger than master brand.

Usage rules

- Protect clear space equal to the width of the central vertical spear on all sides.
- Never stretch, skew, rotate or add drop shadows to the production logo.
- Use metallic/rust texture only in campaign art; garment embroidery and screen print should simplify the finish.
- At small sizes use the crest or wordmark alone; do not force the full lockup into unreadable spaces.
- Primary garment mark colors: Ash, Blood Oath Red, Oxide Copper or tonal black. Avoid bright white unless contrast requires it.

05 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

Typography & Colour

Gothic atmosphere with modern performance discipline.

Typography system

Role	Typeface	Treatment
Display / collection	Cinzel SemiBold or EB Garamond Bold	Wide tracking, uppercase, generous whitespace.
Editorial / manifesto	EB Garamond	Sentence case, restrained italics for quotes.
Functional / product	Inter Medium / Regular	Uppercase labels, short technical copy, tight hierarchy.
Japanese	Noto Serif JP / Noto Sans JP	Match serif/sans role; never use novelty “Asian” fonts.



Palette ratio

Obsidian and Charcoal should dominate roughly 80–90% of any garment or campaign frame. Blood Oath Red is the energy accent. Oxide Copper is the premium/aged-metal accent. Ash provides legibility and worn-steel contrast.

Colour	Role	Recommended use
Obsidian #0A0A0B	Primary base	Garments, backgrounds, packaging.
Charcoal #202023	Secondary base	Panels, washed fabric, UI surfaces.
Ash #B8B1A7	Neutral contrast	Type, embroidery, aged print.
Blood Oath #98181D	Primary accent	Small graphics, seams, campaign light.
Oxide Copper #975A36	Premium accent	Hardware, foil, labels, distress texture.

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Graphic Language

Soulsborne atmosphere without borrowed IP.

Visual ingredients

- Forged metal, oxidised copper, scratched steel and soot-black surfaces.
- Cathedral-like verticality, ruined stone, chains, arches and monumental negative space.
- Blood-red eclipse / circular brush marks used as abstract symbolism rather than a copied franchise motif.
- Spear, thorn, fracture, sigil and blade geometry derived from the VYNKÆR crest.
- Japanese microtype, serial codes, garment specs and training doctrine as secondary information.
- Low-saturation photography with hard side light, mist, grain and controlled red/copper practical lighting.

What not to use

Do not reproduce copyrighted characters, armor designs, manga panels, game logos, named locations, exact symbols or recognisable key art from Berserk, Dark Souls, Bloodborne or any other property. The public-facing brand should describe the aesthetic as dark gothic, fallen-kingdom, forged-metal, industrial and mythic — not as an imitation of a specific franchise.

Graphic scale	Purpose	Examples
Micro	Identity	2–4 cm crest, neck print, hem code, cap embroidery.
Mid	Garment language	10–18 cm chest mark, sleeve sigil, short doctrine copy.
Hero	Collection statement	25–35 cm back graphic, full hood/back panel, campaign poster.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

The garment must still look premium when the graphic is removed. Silhouette comes first; art amplifies it.

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Collection 001 — Forged Soul

The first uniform.



Visual direction reference approved for Collection 001.

FORGED SOUL establishes the VYNKÆR codes with one controlled palette and six pieces. The collection moves from oversized warm-up layers to fitted performance garments, allowing the wearer to arrive covered, train with intent and leave in the same visual system.

Collection doctrine

Element	Decision
Core palette	Washed black / charcoal with Blood Oath red and Oxide Copper accents.
Graphic density	Minimal front, stronger back or side detail.
Silhouette	Broad shoulders, controlled drape, athletic legs, clean vertical lines.
Finish	Matte fabric; distressed print; restrained metallic hardware.
Drop strategy	One dominant colourway at launch. Variants follow only after product validation.

08 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

Launch Product Matrix

Six pieces. One coherent uniform.

Code	Product	Family	Function	Target material
VK-FRG-TEE-01	Forge Tee 01	FORGE	Pump cover / street-gym crossover	240–280 gsm combed cotton
VK-CMB-TEE-01	Combat Tee 01	COMBAT	Fitted performance training	180–220 gsm poly/elastane
VK-FRG-SHO-01	Forge Shorts 01	FORGE	Strength + conditioning	150–190 gsm nylon/elastane
VK-CMB-LS-01	Compression 01	COMBAT	Base layer / performance	200–230 gsm poly/elastane
VK-DSC-HOD-01	Discipline Hoodie 01	DISCIPLINE	Warm-up / lifestyle	400–460 gsm heavyweight fleece
VK-DSC-CAP-01	Training Cap 01	DISCIPLINE	Daily identifier	Heavy cotton twill

Fit architecture

- FORGE = relaxed / oversized silhouettes with weight and drape.
- COMBAT = close-to-body, stretch, sweat management and full range of motion.
- DISCIPLINE = structured outerwear and accessories; clean enough for daily wear.
- Future ASCENSION family = conditioning/running pieces once the core collection is validated.

LAUNCH DISCIPLINE

Do not launch unnecessary colourways or 12+ SKUs. Fit, fabric and finish must prove themselves before breadth.

09 // VYNKÆR APPAREL

Product Specifications I

FORGE TEE 01 / COMBAT TEE 01

01 — FORGE TEE 01

Heavyweight oversized tee

Component	Direction
Fit	Boxy oversized; dropped shoulder; slightly longer sleeve; straight hem.
Fabric	240–280 gsm combed cotton; enzyme wash or garment wash for dry, worn hand feel.
Front	2.5–3.5 cm VYNKÆR wordmark or micro crest at left/centre chest in Ash.
Back	Large 鍛魂 hero typography or crest-derived sigil, 26–32 cm high; small “TRAIN / ENDURE / ADAPT / ASCEND” below.
Detail	Oxide Copper woven hem tab; internal neck print; optional subtle Blood Oath distress at lower side seam.
Colour	Obsidian wash only for first production run.

02 — COMBAT TEE 01

Fitted short-sleeve performance top

Component	Direction
Fit	Athletic fitted torso with room through shoulder/lat; raglan or anatomically placed shoulder seam.
Fabric	180–220 gsm matte polyester/elastane with four-way stretch and moisture management.
Front	Small crest at sternum; no oversized front artwork.
Back	Thin vertical spear/line from upper spine with small VYNKÆR utility text.
Detail	Blood Oath seam piping or bartack accents; reflective micro mark optional only if subtle.
Colour	Near-black with tonal charcoal body panels.

Product Specifications I — Continued

FORGE SHORTS 01

03 — FORGE SHORTS 01

5–7 inch performance shorts

Component	Direction
Fit	Athletic thigh, split/gusset for deep squat and conditioning movement.
Fabric	150–190 gsm nylon/elastane; matte, quick-dry; mesh pocket bags.
Front	Small crest lower left; VYNKÆR utility line near hem.
Side/Back	Vertical Japanese accent on right side; no large rear-seat graphic.
Detail	Copper-tone eyelets/tips; internal drawcord option; secure phone/zip pocket.
Colour	Obsidian with Blood Oath micro accents.

Movement & quality test

Test	Pass condition
Deep squat	No waistband roll, crotch pull or pocket flare.
Lunge / split stance	Hem does not bind thigh; gusset remains comfortable.
Bike / row / sled	Fabric dries quickly and phone pocket stays secure.
Wash	No red transfer; hardware and print remain stable after 5 cycles.

Product Specifications II

COMPRESSION 01 / DISCIPLINE HOODIE 01

04 — COMPRESSION 01

Long-sleeve performance base layer

Component	Direction
Fit	Second-skin through torso and arms; underarm/gusset construction to preserve overhead movement.
Fabric	200–230 gsm poly/elastane; flatlock seams; high recovery.
Front	Tonal wordmark or micro crest at sternum.
Back	Vertical crest-spear line or tiny collection code below neck.
Sleeves	Blood Oath / Oxide Copper sigil fragments at forearms; asymmetry acceptable.
Colour	Obsidian/charcoal only.

05 — DISCIPLINE HOODIE 01

Heavyweight oversized hoodie

Component	Direction
Fit	Oversized but structured; broad shoulder; deep hood; clean rib; not excessively long.
Fabric	400–460 gsm cotton-rich fleece; brushed interior or dense loopback depending climate.
Front	Small centred VYNKÆR or crest embroidery.
Back	Primary collection statement: crest + “FORGED SOUL” / 鍛魂 treatment; distressed red/copper limited to 2–3 inks.
Detail	Metal zip/eyelet accents only if durable and washable; woven internal collection label.
Colour	Deep Obsidian; optional washed Charcoal only after core validation.

Product Specifications II — Continued

TRAINING CAP 01 + trim standards

06 — TRAINING CAP 01

Minimal six-panel training/lifestyle cap

Component	Direction
Fit	Low-to-mid profile; adjustable rear; curved brim.
Fabric	Washed cotton twill or technical matte nylon depending supplier quality.
Front	Small crest embroidery, 30–38 mm high.
Side	VYNKÆR wordmark micro embroidery.
Back	ヴィンケア or collection code above closure.
Hardware	Oxide Copper buckle/clip if corrosion-resistant; otherwise matte black.

Trim & embroidery standard

Element	Standard
Crest embroidery	Simplify micro texture; preserve sharp central spear and outer silhouette.
Thread	Matte Ash, Blood Oath red or copper-tone; avoid high-gloss metallic thread on performance pieces.
Hardware	Matte black first; Oxide Copper only where finish passes sweat/corrosion testing.
Labels	Black woven base, Ash type, optional single red stitch accent.

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Front / Back Graphic System

A repeatable rule for every garment.

Zone	Rule	Collection 001 execution
Front	Identity first. Keep 60–85% negative space.	Micro crest or wordmark only; rare mid-scale sigil.
Back	Narrative surface. One hero idea only.	鍛魂 / crest-derived sigil / forged-soul composition.
Sleeve	Technical accent.	Vertical code, sigil fragment or Japanese microtype.
Hem	Authenticity / product data.	Woven tab, collection number, family code.
Inside neck	Information, not decoration.	Size, composition, care, VYNKÆR lockup.

Hero back graphic recipe

- One dominant symbol: crest, 鍛魂 or spear-derived sigil.
- One secondary line: FORGED SOUL, STRENGTH UNDER CONTROL or TRAIN / ENDURE / ADAPT / ASCEND.
- One technical layer: collection number, product family or coordinate-style serial treatment.
- Maximum three print colors on first production run: Ash, Blood Oath, Oxide Copper.
- Distress texture should appear physically plausible — abrasion, oxidisation, soot — not random grunge noise.

PRINT TEST

Every back graphic must pass two views: readable as a silhouette from 5 m, rewarding in detail from 50 cm.

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Product Naming & SKU System

Every name should communicate family, form and sequence.

Consumer-facing format

VYNKÆR [Family] [Product] [Sequence] — [Colour]

Example: VYNKÆR FORGE TEE 01 — OBSIDIAN

Internal SKU format

VK-[FAMILY]-[TYPE]-[SEQ]-[COLOUR]-[SIZE]

Code	Meaning	Examples
FRG	FORGE family	TEE / SHO
CMB	COMBAT family	TEE / LS
DSC	DISCIPLINE family	HOD / CAP
ASC	ASCENSION family	Future run/conditioning
OBS	Obsidian	Primary launch colour
CHR	Charcoal	Secondary dark neutral
BLD	Blood Oath	Accent / future special piece
OXC	Oxide Copper	Accent / trim reference

Full example: VK-FRG-TEE-01-OBS-L = Forge Tee 01, Obsidian, Large.

Collection naming logic

Collection names should sound like chapters in the same mythology: short, physical and transformative. Examples for future exploration: ASHEN RITE, IRON VOW, AFTER THE FALL, BLACK ASCENSION. Use only after trademark and cultural review.

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Packaging & Unboxing

Premium enough to feel authored; efficient enough to scale.

Launch-ready packaging

Layer	Specification	Reason
Outer	Matte black recycled mailer or black kraft e-commerce box	Low MOQ, protects the dark identity.
Closure	Blood Oath red tamper sticker / crest seal	One strong accent with low cost.
Wrap	Black or charcoal tissue	Creates ritual without excessive packaging.
Product band	Uncoated black card, Ash type, collection number	Keeps folded garments ordered.
Insert	A6 doctrine card in warm black + copper/ash	Brand story, care, QR to training content.
Label	Woven black label + Ash type; red stitch accent	Premium tactile identity.

Unboxing sequence

- Crest seal.
- Doctrine card: “FORGED, NOT BORN.”
- Folded garment with product band.
- Inside label reveals collection number and family code.
- QR leads to product care + Collection 001 training film / playlist / manifesto page.

Phase-two collector treatment

After demand is proven, introduce a rigid black box, blind-debossed crest, copper foil detail and individually numbered first-run card. Do not burden the first launch with expensive packaging before unit economics are validated.

Launch Campaign — ENTER THE FORGE

The campaign sells an identity by showing the work.

CAMPAIGN LINE

ENTER THE FORGE. LEAVE MORE CAPABLE.

Visual world

- Raw training environment: concrete, iron, chalk, chains, plate steel, worn leather and controlled mist.
- Near-black grade with red practical light and restrained copper highlights.
- Bodies shown under effort — bracing, gripping, sprinting, carrying, stretching — not only posing.
- Hard close-ups of hands, fabric, breath, sweat, seams and hardware.
- Mythic inserts: ruins, arches, eclipse-like circular forms, ash and forged metal; always original imagery.

Three-phase rollout

Phase	Timing	Content	Objective
I — THE MARK	T-14 to T-8	Crest fragments, fabric macros, one-line doctrine, founder training shots.	Recognition + curiosity.
II — THE UNIFORM	T-7 to T-2	Six-piece reveals, fit videos, detail posts, collection film trailer.	Product understanding + waitlist.
III — ENTER THE FORGE	T-1 to Drop	Hero film, lookbook, product pages, founder message, launch countdown.	Conversion.
IV — AFTER THE DROP	D+1 onward	Real training footage, customer fits, product testing, care content.	Proof + retention.

Hero film — 30–45 seconds

Open on darkness and metal. A red line appears through the crest. Cut to wrapping hands, tightening shoes, loading plates, first heavy breath. Alternate controlled lifting with short conditioning and mobility images. The product is always visible but never staged like a catalogue. End on the crest, FORGED SOUL and the line: ENTER THE FORGE. LEAVE MORE CAPABLE.

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Launch Content System

Every post should reinforce one of four jobs.

Content pillar	Purpose	Examples
Doctrine	Meaning	Short lines, founder philosophy, training principles.
Product	Proof	Fabric, fit, stitching, graphics, wash tests, motion.
Training	Credibility	Real sessions: strength, conditioning, mobility, progression.
World	Atmosphere	Campaign stills, sound, architecture, metal, ash, original dark-fantasy art.

Launch asset minimum

- 1 hero campaign film (30–45 s).
- 6 product reveal reels, one per launch piece.
- 12–18 editorial stills: front, back, movement, detail.
- 6 clean e-commerce product image sets.
- 1 founder statement explaining why VYNKÆR exists.
- 1 collection landing page with manifesto, product grid and sizing/care.
- 1 post-drop testing video showing actual training use.

FOUNDER ADVANTAGE

The strongest early differentiator is authenticity: the founder should train in the products, document iteration and let the audience see why each detail exists.

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Production & Brand Guardrails

What must remain true as VYNKÆR scales.

Area	Non-negotiable
Silhouette	Fit must work under movement before graphics are approved.
Quality	No thin promotional blanks for core products.
Palette	Black/charcoal remains dominant; red/copper stay accents.
Logo	No uncontrolled variants or distorted marks.
Copy	No generic beast-mode / alpha / pain-fetish language.
IP	No copyrighted characters, symbols, logos or recognisable key art.
Japanese	Native review before production where text is prominent.
Legal	Trademark search/filing for VYNKÆR wordmark and crest in apparel-relevant classes before major inventory.
Claims	Performance claims must match tested fabric/garment capability.

Sampling sequence

- Prototype silhouette in plain fabric first.
- Fit test through squat, hinge, press, pull, sprint/row/bike motion and mobility positions as relevant.
- Wash test at least 3–5 cycles before artwork sign-off.
- Print/embroidery test on actual production fabric.
- Review logo size from 5 m and 50 cm.
- Approve final tech pack only after movement, wash and finishing issues are closed.

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From Bible to First Sample

Immediate execution plan.

Priority	Decision / deliverable	Status
P0	Lock primary crest, wordmark and production-ready vector files.	NEXT
P0	Choose supplier path and target garment cost / retail positioning.	NEXT
P0	Build tech packs for all six pieces with measurements and artwork placements.	NEXT
P0	Order blank/fabric swatches and first fit samples.	NEXT
P1	Create final front/back artwork for Forge Tee and Discipline Hoodie first.	NEXT
P1	Test embroidery size for crest and cap.	NEXT
P1	Prototype packaging at low MOQ.	NEXT
P1	Build collection landing page + waitlist.	NEXT
P2	Shoot campaign only after final samples match intended fit.	LATER
P2	Open first production run based on validated sizing/costing.	LATER

Recommended first physical sample

Start with FORGE TEE 01. It has the lowest technical complexity, carries the brand language clearly and lets VYNKÆR validate fit, fabric weight, logo scale, back graphic execution, wash behaviour and packaging before committing to more complex performance pieces.

COLLECTION 001 NORTH STAR

A person should be able to recognise VYNKÆR before reading the logo: black weight, controlled silhouette, a vertical weapon-like geometry, one red/copper wound of colour, and absolute restraint everywhere else.

VYNKÆR // ヴィンケア // 鍛魂

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